

Tiara Trio

They're opening movies, pushing brands, cherry-picking projects, and gracing glossy covers. They're the new queens of Bollywood.

| By Kaveree Bamzai |

Kareena Kapoor is in Dubai shooting round the clock for *Main Aur Mrs Khanna* with Salman Khan. "They only have me till the end of the week, so we have to wrap up work," she says briskly. Priyanka Chopra is in and out of cinema halls with director Madhur Bhandarkar checking audience reaction to her new film, *Fashion*. "I was really nervous about shouldering a film on my own, so I'm glad it worked," she says as she walks away from the event. Katrina Kaif, just back from a shoot in Philadelphia, is in the middle of shooting an advertisement for Nakshatra, a brand where she has replaced Aishwarya Rai. "My own time? What's that? I guess only when I'm in the car, listening to my iPod in between shoots." With 18 days for endorsements and four movies a year, it's clear why.

They're Bollywood's tiara trio, women who are opening movies, pushing brands, making public appearances, and keeping news television and colourful tabloids alive. All in between fittings for movies,

photo shoots for magazine covers and power partying. Kareena's latest release, the Rs 25-crore *Golmaal Returns*, a no-brainer comedy which starred four men, had her at the forefront of the publicity, powering two music videos for the movie's promotion. The movie has already made Rs 35 crore in the first week. Priyanka's new film, released in the same week, had her in almost every frame, tracing her arc from a small time wanna-shine to super-model and back. The film has practically no recognisable male lead, and those who are well-known play gay. Yet the Rs 17.5-crore *Fashion* made Rs 20 crore in the first week. Katrina, who has successfully played arm candy to Akshay Kumar in a series of blockbusters, *Namaste London*, *Welcome* and most recently *Singh is Kinng*, is now practically the face of Subhash Ghai's new film *Yuvvraaj*. Even as she looks very fetching in an updo and a cello, it's almost easy to forget that the movie features three male stars, Salman

PEACHY PRINCESS

Katrina KAIF, 24

Rs 2 crore a movie, six brands at over Rs 2 crore each

COMING UP *Yuvvraaj*, where she's a cello player in the classic mould

“Why can't a woman carry a film on her own? It's the story that matters, not the star. Look at *Phoonk*. It had no one.”

